Reference: Announcement Categories & Financial Glossary

A companion to the Build Challenge brief. You do not need a finance background — this document explains the corporate-announcement categories and the financial terms and documents referenced in the main brief. Lean on it freely.

---

1. Corporate announcement categories

How we classify the announcements companies file with the exchanges. In the main brief this is offered as guidance only — you may use it, adapt it, or ignore it.

Category	What goes in it
results	Quarterly/annual results, the board meeting approving them, results decks and shareholder letters, and ads confirming results were published.
M&A	Any acquisition, merger, demerger, or joint venture — including investing in a subsidiary, or selling a stake in one.
fund_raise	Raising money from outside investors — rights issues, QIPs, preferential allotments, buybacks, or debt like commercial paper.
management_change	Any change at the top — a CEO, CFO, MD, or director joining, resigning, or retiring.
litigation	Lawsuits, regulatory orders, fines, warnings, or insolvency/restructuring proceedings.
insider_trading	A promoter or insider buying/selling their own personal shareholding.
earnings_call	Anything about the investor conference call — the notice, the transcript, or the recording link.
investor_meetings	One-on-one or small-group meetings with specific investors/funds, or attending an investor conference.
credit_rating	A rating agency assigning, upgrading, downgrading, or reaffirming a credit rating.
dividend	A cash dividend being declared, with its record date.
bonus_split	A bonus issue or stock split — share count changes but no cash comes to you.
capex	Approving spend on a new plant, facility, or capacity expansion.
press_release	General news — order wins, new products, partnerships, rumour clarifications — not covered by another category.
postal_ballot	Shareholders voting by postal ballot — the notice and the result.
agm_egm	Annual or Extraordinary General Meeting — the notice and the result.
pledging	A promoter pledging, releasing, or changing the pledge status of shares.
unclassified	Routine, low-relevance paperwork — ESOP allotments, compliance certificates, ESG reports, auditor appointments — that doesn't materially move the stock.

2. Documents you'll work with

Annual Report (AR) — A company's yearly disclosure. Contains the business overview, management discussion, audited financial statements (P&L, balance sheet, cash-flow), and the notes and auditor's report. The single richest primary source.

Quarterly results — The financial results a company publishes every quarter (revenue, profit, etc.), filed with the exchanges. Less detailed than the annual report but far more current.

Concall / earnings-call transcript — A quarterly call where management discusses the results and answers analysts' questions. The transcript is where you find guidance, tone, and what analysts are pressing on.

Investor presentation — A slide deck management releases (often with results) framing strategy, KPIs, and segment performance in their own words.

Exchange filing / announcement — Any disclosure a listed company files with NSE/BSE — the raw feed the push side monitors.

screener.in — A widely-used site that consolidates a company's annual reports, concall transcripts, and standardised multi-year financials in one place — the easiest place to fetch fundamentals.

Primary vs. secondary data — Primary data comes straight from the company (filings, reports, transcripts). Secondary data is other people's commentary on it (news, broker notes, research reports). The pull/analysis side of this challenge must use primary data only.

3. Headline financial terms

Revenue — Total sales — the top line of the P&L; the money coming in from selling goods/services.

EBITDA — Earnings Before Interest, Tax, Depreciation & Amortisation. A rough proxy for operating profitability — how profitable the core business is before financing and accounting effects.

PBT — Profit Before Tax — profit after all costs and interest but before income tax.

PAT — Profit After Tax — the bottom line; what's left for shareholders after tax. Also called "net profit."

Margin — A profit figure as a % of revenue (e.g. EBITDA margin = EBITDA ÷ revenue). Shows how much of each rupee of sales becomes profit.

QoQ (quarter-on-quarter) — This quarter compared with the immediately previous quarter.

YoY (year-on-year) — This quarter compared with the same quarter a year earlier — the usual way to strip out seasonality.

4. Balance-sheet, cash & ratio terms

Balance sheet — A snapshot of what a company owns (assets) and owes (liabilities) at a point in time, plus shareholders' equity.

Debt / leverage — Money the company has borrowed. "Leverage" describes how much debt it carries relative to its equity or earnings — more debt means more risk.

Debt-to-Equity (D/E) — A leverage ratio: total debt ÷ shareholders' equity. Higher = more reliance on borrowing.

Working-capital cycle — The cash tied up in day-to-day operations — inventory and money owed by customers, minus money owed to suppliers. A lengthening cycle can quietly drain cash.

Cash flow — The actual cash moving in and out, as opposed to accounting profit. "Cash from operations" is the cash the core business generates.

Cash conversion — How well accounting profit turns into real cash. Persistent profit without matching cash flow is a red flag.

Free cash flow (FCF) — Cash from operations minus capital spending — the cash genuinely left over.

ROCE / ROE — Return on Capital Employed / Return on Equity — how much profit the company generates per rupee of capital / shareholders' money. Higher is generally better.

Contingent liabilities — Potential future obligations (e.g. disputed taxes, guarantees) disclosed in the notes — not yet on the balance sheet but worth watching.

Related-party transactions (RPTs) — Deals between the company and its own promoters/insiders or their other businesses — legitimate but a place to watch for value leaking out.

Auditor's qualification — When the auditor flags a concern about the accounts rather than signing off cleanly — a signal to dig deeper.

5. Corporate-action & market terms

NSE / BSE — India's two main stock exchanges (National / Bombay Stock Exchange). Listed companies file their announcements here.

Ticker / symbol — A stock's short code. On Yahoo Finance, Indian tickers add .NS (NSE) or .BO (BSE) — e.g. RELIANCE.NS.

Market capitalisation — The total market value of a company's shares (share price × number of shares). A rough measure of company size.

Promoter — The controlling shareholder / founding group of an Indian listed company.

Pledging — A promoter using their own shares as collateral for a loan. Heavy pledging is a risk signal.

Material announcement — A disclosure significant enough to potentially move the stock, as opposed to routine compliance paperwork.

Guidance — Management's own stated forward expectations — for growth, margins, capex, and so on.

Capex (capital expenditure) — Spending on long-term assets like new plants or capacity.

Dividend — A cash payout to shareholders from profits.

Record date — The cut-off date deciding who's eligible for a dividend, bonus, or split.

Bonus issue / stock split — Corporate actions that increase your share count without any cash changing hands; each share is worth proportionally less.

Buyback — A company buying back its own shares from the market, usually returning surplus cash to shareholders.

Rights issue / QIP / preferential allotment — Ways a company raises fresh equity — from existing shareholders (rights), from institutions (QIP = Qualified Institutional Placement), or to specific investors (preferential allotment).

EOD (end-of-day) — Data taken after market close — the daily close price and traded volume used on the push side.